8.4 Green Revolution and White Revolution

Green Revolution

Introduction

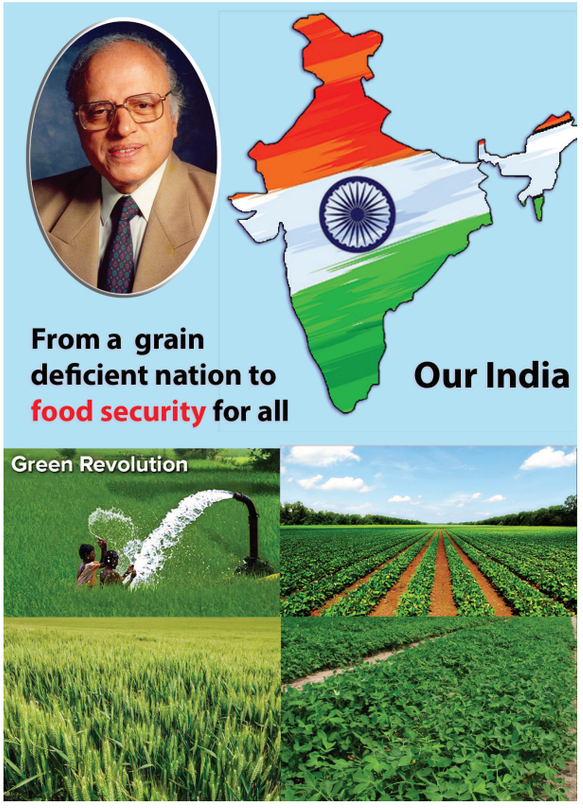
Agriculture has been the most intensive form of economic activity leading to 12-15% of its contribution to GDP. Agriculture is not only for sustaining the food grains and vegetation to cater to the requirements of the growing population but has its contribution in creating largest employment sector, fostering one large section of the Indian industry called Agrarian Industry and has been contributing and earning foreign exchange to our nation. Agriculture is not just grains alone, but it spreads to various Agricultural Tertiary sectors such as Coconut Farming, Orchids and cash crops such as Cashew Nuts, Coffee, Tea, Pepper and Vegetables.

Activity

- Visit a village and observe the farming activities. Understand ownership, tenancy, agricultural activities and the nature of farming in the village.
- Understand roof top gardening, vertical gardening and organic farming and do an experimentation of the same.

The primary need to sustain Indian agriculture to cater the growing requirements of the population was felt immediately after Independence. However the nature of importance that was given to Agriculture varied from the First Five Year plan to 12th Five Year Plan. Because in the initial years after independence, the importance was given to setting of industry and industrial system in India. In the first 10 years after Independence, with the continuous adoption of primitive technology of farming the agricultural outcome was able to meet the basic needs of the population that was growing around 2.5% annually. It was during the 1960's when India began to face the shortfall in meeting the population needs. Because, the Food Grain production did not increase to cater to the needs of the population. This led to the Green Revolution.

Green Revolution in India



As we all know that India is basically an agricultural country with the growing population dependent on agriculture. With the experience of India's first two five-year plans, it was realised that agriculture in India had serious shortfalls namely,

a) It was not able to produce required grains to suit the growing population.

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